

Psalms 26

Walking in Integrity

Judge me, O Lord; for I have walked in mine integrity
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Judge me, O LORD; for I have walked in mine integrity: I have trusted also in the LORD; therefore I shall not slide.
- 2 Examine me, O LORD, and prove me; try my reins and my heart.
- 3 For thy lovingkindness is before mine eyes: and I have walked in thy truth.
- 4 I have not sat with vain persons, neither will I go in with dissemblers.
- 5 I have hated the congregation of evildoers; and will not sit with the wicked.
- 6 I will wash mine hands in innocency: so will I compass thine altar, O LORD:
- 7 That I may publish with the voice of thanksgiving, and tell of all thy wondrous works.
- 8 LORD, I have loved the habitation of thy house, and the place where thine honour dwelleth.
- 9 Gather not my soul with sinners, nor my life with bloody men:
- 10 In whose hands is mischief, and their right hand is full of bribes.
- 11 But as for me, I will walk in mine integrity: redeem me, and be merciful unto me.
- 12 My foot standeth in an even place: in the congregations will I bless the LORD.

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 26 is a prayer of self-examination and appeal, in which David asks God to judge and try him, confident of a consistent pattern of trust, avoidance of the company of the deceitful, and love for God's house and worship. Henry cautions that this is not sinless self-righteousness but honest testimony offered for God's own scrutiny—an invitation to be tried, not a boast that dismisses correction. The psalm's closing plea to be redeemed and its confidence of standing "in an even place" model integrity held humbly before God rather than flaunted before others.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

An opening plea: judge me, for I have walked in integrity and trusted the Lord without wavering; examine, prove, try my heart and reins, since God's lovingkindness has been continually before David's eyes and he has walked in God's truth.

Verse 4-7

Specific evidence of integrity: not sitting with vain persons, not going in with dissemblers, hating the congregation of evildoers, refusing to sit with the wicked—instead washing hands in innocency, compassing God's altar, and publishing thanksgiving aloud.

Verse 8-10

Love for God's house and the place where His honor dwells contrasted with a plea not to be gathered with sinners, bloody men whose hands hold mischief and bribes—company and worship location reveal the heart's true allegiance.

Verse 11-12

A closing resolve to walk in integrity, paired with humble petition—"redeem me, and be merciful unto me." The psalm ends in settled confidence: "My foot standeth in an even place: in the congregations will I bless the Lord."

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Integrity before God includes honest self-examination, deliberate avoidance of corrupting company, and genuine love for worship, held together with humble dependence on God's mercy rather than self-congratulation.

Application for life today.

Invite God's scrutiny of your heart the way David does, rather than only defending yourself to others. Take an honest look at the company you keep—not with paranoid isolation, but with discernment about influences that quietly normalize deceit or evildoing. And let love for corporate worship ("I have loved the habitation of thy house") be a visible marker of where your heart's true allegiance lies.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. Where might you be avoiding God’s honest examination of your heart by focusing only on others’ faults?

2. What company or influences in your life quietly pull you toward compromise, and what would “washing your hands in innocence” look like there?

3. Does your love for corporate worship reflect the priority David describes in verse 8—why or why not?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).